

Skills

Performing Oral Hygiene for an Unconscious Patient

Checklist

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S = Satisfactory U = Unsatisfactory NP = Not Performed

Step	S	U	NP	Comments
Introduced self to patient and family and explained procedure; if patient was conscious, ensured he or she agreed to treatment.	☐	☐	☐	
Identified patient using two identifiers, compared with information on patient's ID bracelet.	☐	☐	☐	
Performed hand hygiene.	☐	☐	☐	
Provided for patient privacy.	☐	☐	☐	
Placed towel on overbed table, arranged equipment.	☐	☐	☐	
Raised bed to a comfortable working height, positioned patient appropriately, lowered side rails.	☐	☐	☐	
Applied clean gloves.	☐	☐	☐	
Tested for presence of gag reflex, inspected condition of oral cavity.	☐	☐	☐	
Inspected patient's mouth for signs of tartar, swollen or bleeding gums, ulcerations, debris, and severe halitosis, removed patient's dentures or partial plates when present, and safely stored them for proper cleaning in an appropriate container labeled with the patient's name.	☐	☐	☐	
Removed and disposed of gloves.	☐	☐	☐	
Tested suction catheter when needed.	☐	☐	☐	
Positioned patient appropriately.	☐	☐	☐	
Turned patient's head properly, placed towel under head.	☐	☐	☐	

Applied clean pair of gloves.

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Placed an emesis basin under patient's chin.

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Put an oral airway in place when necessary, did not use force.

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Used floss or another interdental device (soft pick) at least once a day before brushing the teeth, if possible.

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Suctioned any secretions, cleaned mouth using a wet toothbrush, applied toothpaste or therapeutic solution, loosened any crusts.

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Applied toothpaste, cleansed tooth surfaces properly, used toothette sponge and tongue blade when necessary.

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Cleaned chewing and inner surfaces of teeth, then outer surfaces and gum line.

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Brushed the inner and outer surfaces of the upper and lower teeth from the gum line to the crown of each tooth. Cleaned the biting surfaces of the teeth by holding the toothbrush bristles perpendicular to the teeth and brushing gently back and forth. Brushed the sides of the teeth by gently moving the bristles back and forth.

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Used a bulb syringe filled with water to rinse the mouth and repeated as needed. Moistened the toothbrush or foam-tipped applicator with an appropriate therapeutic mouth rinse and cleanse the oral cavity, ensuring contact of the therapeutic mouth rinse with all oral cavity structures. Used the brush or a toothette to clean the roof of the mouth, the gums, and inside the cheeks.

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Brushed tongue, avoided stimulating gag reflex, repeated rinsing action, used suction when necessary.

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If a toothbrush could not be used, rinsed the roof of the mouth, gums, and inside of the cheeks with a toothette sponge.

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Used gloved finger or toothette sponge to apply moisturizer to patient's lips.

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Informed patient when procedure was completed, returned patient to safe comfortable position.

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Raised side rails and lowered bed to ensure patient safety.

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Cleaned equipment, returned to proper place, disposed of soiled linen appropriately.

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Removed and discarded gloves, performed hand hygiene.

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Documented patient's oral care.

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Learner: _____
Evaluator: _____
Date: _____

Signature: _____
Signature: _____